

Language Impact Checklist

Language Challenges Indicating Adverse Impact on Educational Performance

How to use this checklist: Check the behaviors that are **frequently observed** and that appear to be the result of the child's language difficulty. Consider age and grade level appropriateness for each item.

Student Name: _____

Date of Birth: _____

Date: _____

Completed by (name & title): _____

Impact on Reading

- ☐ Has difficulty with phonological awareness aspects of reading readiness (rhyming, segmenting, discriminating, sound-symbol, blending)
- ☐ Poor comprehension of written material (text and stories)
- ☐ Difficulty recalling facts or details from text
- ☐ Difficulty making inferences (cause-effect, outcome) from discussions or reading

Impact on Organization

- ☐ Generally disorganized (care of school supplies, routines)
- ☐ Cannot explain class routines
- ☐ Fails to demonstrate logical thinking
- ☐ Difficulty completing assignments, in class and/or homework
- ☐ Difficulty with note taking
- ☐ Difficulty mastering new concepts
- ☐ Does poorly on tests, quizzes
- ☐ Loses belongings more than other children

Impact on Strategies

- ☐ Verbal production and retention improves when visuals are provided or generated
- ☐ Must have concrete examples to solve abstract problems
- ☐ Does better on multiple-choice tests than essay type
- ☐ Watches other children to know what to do
- ☐ Asks other students for help on assignments

Impact on Classroom Communication

- ☐ Speaks in incomplete sentences, short sentences or single words; limited oral output
- ☐ Unable to provide labels for objects, events, people, and places
- ☐ Uses nonspecific vocabulary (thing, stuff, junk)
- ☐ Pauses or has difficulty thinking of words (word finding)
- ☐ Talks "around" words
- ☐ Uses gestures and/or sound effects to gain attention or help express ideas
- ☐ Difficulty asking and answering questions
- ☐ Cannot tell a story or express a sequence of events clearly
- ☐ Rambles with no sense of order or getting to the point
- ☐ Difficulty paraphrasing or summarizing
- ☐ Abstract/figurative language is confusing
- ☐ Jokes, idioms, and sarcasm are not understood
- ☐ Not able to remember facts or details from spoken presentations
- ☐ Expects the listener to know what they are talking about without context (no referent)

Impact on Math

- ☐ Difficulty understanding and expressing quantity
- ☐ Needs manipulatives to solve math problems
- ☐ Difficulty with basic math concepts (+, -, carry, borrow)
- ☐ Cannot explain thinking after solving math problems
- ☐ Poor problem solving, reasoning, and estimating
- ☐ Difficulty solving word problems
- ☐ Difficulty expressing time and sequence concepts

Impact on Class Participation & Social Skills

- ☐ Hesitates or avoids oral participation in class
- ☐ Limited participation in group discussions
- ☐ Does not request assistance or clarification
- ☐ Difficulty remembering and following directions
- ☐ Often requests for directions to be repeated
- ☐ Questions or directions have to be repeated
- ☐ Appears not to listen and attend (may be visually attending to surroundings)
- ☐ Has little or no successful interaction with peers
- ☐ Reluctant to initiate conversation
- ☐ Appears socially isolated due to communication difficulties

- ☐ Seldom attends to the spoken language of others
- ☐ Cannot reason through situations and respond appropriately, resulting in poor social skills
- ☐ Cannot use language to resolve conflicts

Impact on Written Language

- ☐ Errors in writing reflect errors in oral language
- ☐ Poor grammar (pronouns, verb forms, prepositions), orally or in writing
- ☐ Difficulty formulating written sentences
- ☐ Limited amount of writing in journal
- ☐ Creative writing is difficult
- ☐ Poor organization in story writing
- ☐ Needs to verbalize or draw the story before writing
- ☐ Makes errors when writing from dictation
- ☐ Difficulty editing written material
- ☐ Difficulty with Daily Oral Language or other sentence analysis activities
- ☐ Poor vocabulary reflected on tests and assignments
- ☐ Does not form/see word associations or do word webbing well
- ☐ Lack of understanding of parts of speech (nouns, verbs, adverbs, conjunctions)

Additional Comments

Other observations or indications that language adversely affects educational performance:

** Adapted from the NDSP Language Checklist*

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